

the Xbox 360.

Bungie Studios, the developers of Halo, had been rumoured to have been working on the game since a pre-build of the Xbox 360; the effort shows with breath-taking vistas and crisp animations throughout the campaign.

The gameplay, too, is quite marvellous. Bungie has thrown in a vast range of weapons for you to get your hands on, along with enough enemies as fodder at a firing range. The artificial intelligence is top-notch, with your opponents using cover quite smartly, and even flank tactics in higher skill levels.

Halo 3 also steps up the difficulty in the subtlest of ways: while you have a lot of weapons to choose from, the ammunition is scarce. You can't afford to be trigger-happy in this game, and that adds a nice element of realism to the combat.

One of the best aspects throughout the Halo series has been the vehicular combat it offers, and *Halo 3* is no exception, letting you command small jeeps with mounted turrets, motorbikes or choppers, single-seater flying pods, and even huge tanks. Vehicular combat was never this good!

Multiplayer gameplay has been one of the highlights of the Halo series and *Halo 3* does not disappoint. The developers have thrown in some creative maps to go with the new vehicles and airships you can manoeuvre, making *Halo 3* one of the most popular online-play titles for the Xbox 360.

All in all, the game hardly puts a step wrong and is a must-have if you are plonking down your cash for Microsoft's console.

Gears of War

Neither Microsoft nor developer Epic Games ever thought that their Xbox 360-exclusive title, *Gears of War*, would ever be so big. This was the first game to use the Unreal 3 engine, made by the creators of the engine itself, and boy, did it ever shake up the market! In fact, The game and its sequel have become so big that Microsoft has been reportedly considering making it the flagship title instead of Halo.

Gears of War (GoW) is all about co-operative play and is ideal for a two-player campaign. The game revolves around Marcus Fenix, a former soldier who is



One of the most fun arcade shooters of all time, *Gears of War* is also among the best co-op games out there